

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] Okay, I am recording. Okay, awesome. So do you have questions before we get started. Mm hmm. Okay, Awesome. Okay. So thank you so much again for participating in this interview. As I mentioned over text, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships and we believe your experience and perspectives would bring much to the project. So we're going to start with some demographic questions: How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:34] I am now [70-75] years old.

Speaker 1 [00:00:37] Okay. And how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:42] That one is like [duration].

Speaker 1 [00:00:49] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:00:49] Many moons went by.

Speaker 1 [00:00:53] That's what she said too. And do you have any children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:58] No, we don't.

Speaker 1 [00:01:00] Okay. And who lives in your household or in the household.

Speaker 2 [00:01:03] And right now. [1-5] cats. [Name] and [Name]. And a dog named [Name].

Speaker 1 [00:01:09] Oh. I love animals. They're so cute. What is your main source of income and what is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:22] I didn't get that either.

Speaker 1 [00:01:25] What is your main source of income and what is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:34] My source of income is [occupation] from the [company]. And I'm retired.

Speaker 1 [00:01:41] Okay. Yeah. And how would you like us? Or how would you like to address your partner so we can be like, boyfriend, partner, lover, etc., by their name? Any of those words?

Speaker 2 [00:01:59] If some.

Speaker 2: Yeah. There's lag time. Yeah. So yeah. You just have to show it's not your. It is. She'll repeat it.

Speaker 1 [00:02:01] Okay. You want me to repeat? Okay. How would you like us to address your partner so I can be like, boyfriend? Okay. All right. You're back.

Speaker 2 [00:03:18] We're back. So sorry.

Speaker 1 [00:03:20] It's totally fine. No worries at all. I understand. Just going back to my original question. How would you like us to address your partner? This can be like wife, boyfriend, girlfriend, partner, lover, any of those things. By their name. Any of those.

Speaker 2 [00:03:39] How do I address her?

[00:03:41] Hmm? She says I'm a wife.

Speaker 2 [00:03:46] A best friend, a partner. I somebody that I could talk to about everything and anything. And it's no secret between me and her. It's all open.

Speaker 1 [00:04:03] Okay. Yeah. Awesome. Okay. And then. Just for some context, could you tell me about your love story?

Speaker 2 [00:04:14] Between me and her.

Speaker 1 [00:04:16] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:04:18] I was working as a [occupation], [Company], and she was one of the [occupation].

Speaker 2 [00:04:29] She was the one who was close and was the one who was teaching me things that are good here in the [Country] and what is not good like, ironing the pants. And she comes up and you say, Why do you iron your pants? I said, We iron everything. We iron our underwear we iron our undershirt. She said, No, not in the [Company]. I said, Oh, okay. I said, From there on I didn't iron anything. So she taught me a lot of a lot of things. And at that time, we were just friends, close friends. Nothing. Nothing out there would tell you about etiquette. And we didn't know how to greet people and what people would say. Like one time there was the young lady and she comes up to me about maybe 7:00 in the evening before we closed. And she said, See you later.

[00:05:27] So I thought, Oh, okay.

Speaker 2 [00:05:30] So we closed the store and I waited and the girl did not show up. The following morning I asked [Partner's Name] and I said, What do people say when they say, See you later? She said, it's sort of like a goodbye. She said So what happened? I said, I waited. also like etiquette about eating, about how to deal with people. So I learned a lot from her.

Speaker 1 [00:06:04] Yeah, that's a really great story and I love the story about you later because I realize it is a very convoluted term that people use here in the [Country]. Yeah. Another talking about is something else. How would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:06:31] I With what? I'm a little bit hard of hearing.

Speaker 1 [00:06:36] Yeah, that's okay. How would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:06:45] Oh, it's getting better. It's getting better. I got to know her, and she had to know me and. I'm as they say, one time you marry a [Nationality], you marry the entire [location], which means the problem and everything comes with it. And she

understood that. And she never hesitated to help and do things. And that one point of our relationship, when we were just friends, she would advise me things. And when we started getting. Living together. And that's when I started to cope up with my problem with she meant. Like, it's not my problem alone, but it's also her problem.

Speaker 1 [00:07:34] Okay. Yeah, I love that. Can I also ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:07:44] What in the past?

Speaker 1 [00:07:45] Past, how many romantic partners you've had?

Speaker 2 [00:07:53] I wasn't. I was in the service in the [Country]. So there never wasn't a lot. And then I got married. [redacted].

[00:08:16] What the hell.

Speaker 2 [00:08:17] Then I'll see what's going on. She was very nice, but in the long run, things didn't work. And in respect to her, it's not just going to defend herself.

[00:08:30] But.

Speaker 2 [00:08:31] [Redacted]. I talked to [Partner's Name] and [Partner's Name] said, No problem. Will take care of it.

[00:09:05] So.

Speaker 2 [00:09:06] No, it wasn't. And I am married once. And. Before [Partner's Name], there was just, like, the little things and nothing. Nothing serious. [Partner's Name] came in, but nothing.

Speaker 1 [00:09:26]. Yeah. And how would you compare the quality of your relationship now compare to that of your previous relationships? I know you touched on that a little bit, but yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:09:47] Our relationship now than before?

Speaker 1 [00:09:50] Yeah, well, you know, your relationship versus other relationships previously, so, like. I see. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:10:02] With my other relationship. It's always been one way. I hate to say that, but that's the way I look at it. But even though it's that way, I always play the game of, Yeah, it's okay, it's fine. Everything would be done. Everything. The storm would come by and the sun would rise again. That's always been my attitude. But the sun never rise. I just keep going. I just keep hanging. with [Partner's Name], It's always a way to talk to her. It's always it's always been the we situation, not the I. And so we what are we going to do? How are we going to solve it? Why are you upset? Why is this going on? Why is this happening? And with her, there is no yelling. on the other side, there was a lot of yelling and there was a lot of downgrading that Now I married her because of her citizenship. And all of those little thing that I was nobody. And with [Partner's Name], there was nothing, no subject like that. For her, it's always, as I've said, it's a way to make this to make this situation work, to make. partners and work both of us as to work relationship to me is not

just like going to a coffee shop or eating. Or watching TV. Relationship is of work is a full time work. You cannot ignore little things. If I notice something is wrong, I go to her. And if she won't give me an answer, I'll go get a chocolate. I'll go get an ice cream. And that would solve the.

[00:11:52] Problem.

Speaker 2 [00:11:53] Again. Ask for anything that would solve the problem. Then she would tell me what's going on. And the same thing with her. I cannot hide my feeling if something is bothering me. And she doesn't ignore that. She always comes up to me and say, So. What's wrong? What's going on? What is that? What is that? And that makes the relationship better. And sort of like you're planting something. But to plant something without watering it, the plant's going to die. So you have to keep watering it watering. And yes, I do question myself sometimes. Do I have the right person with me? She's white. She's [Religion]. She's still educated. Me, I'm short. I'm [Nationality]. A [religion]. We call it I'm only a [educational attainment] finished. I did not graduate in a [educational attainment] day. I learned a lot from her. And I thought, am I putting her down.

[00:12:56] Or am I.

Speaker 2 [00:12:58] Am I, am I the right person for her or whatnot? But it seems to me like she's happy with it. She's happy with what she got. So we just do what we ask the Question Are you happy? Are you okay? And she would say, Yes, I'm okay and I'm okay and I'm okay. So we go out, we wander around, and I kind of like would like to notice anything that would say that that would make me feel like she's not happy. And we talk about it. If one of us is not happy, just say it. And if we cannot solve the problem, then maybe that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:13:40] Yeah. I'm glad you were able to find a great relationship. And for you, what makes a relationship? High quality or low quality? And why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:13:54] Which one?

Speaker 1 [00:13:56] Yeah. What what makes a relationship higher quality or. Well, I'm sorry. I found this on the web. What makes a relationship more high quality or more low quality? And why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:14:16] High quality.

Speaker 1 [00:14:18] High or low quality.

Speaker 2 [00:14:22] And I say that. Because it's not just like as I've said, it's not just like going to a place, going for a coffee, going for something. It I enjoyed environment that is I enjoyed always the laugh. I enjoyed the way she talk. Everything is is right there. And I have nothing else to ask. And we were young at one point, and we did everything. And sitting. She didn't worry about me being brown going to. Other places that fully, White said. Introduce me to white people, and then everybody has accepted me. I have nothing to ask from her now. We're on our seventies and sixties. I don't think that the quality had gone down. I think it's just going to another the face of life from being doing this to [years] depending on our friendship. And yes, right now we're talking about how do we cope up with life with our little pension. And I think we're doing good. So this next life, we're looking forward. We're going for a [1-5] day. Road trip. And it's one that I've been looking for. And I

know that some of my friends have stopped living. Like for them, this is it. We're [70-75]. We stay home. We watch [Name] and that's it for us. No being [70-75] and [60-65], this is not going to get us inside the house. We're going out.

Speaker 1 [00:16:12] Yeah, that's great. I love that. And for you, what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:25] What is the relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:16:27] Yeah, the most important part or the most important thing.

Speaker 2 [00:16:36] Communication.

Speaker 2 [00:16:38] I think communication is the most important part. And showing that you care for somebody. There are times that you cannot express yourself. And saying, I love you. To me, it's just a word. It's just like a good morning. But you have to back it up with something else. I love you. Doesn't mean anything to me. It just like. Good morning. Good morning. But you have to back it up. You have to do something to prove that. That what you're saying or you don't have to say I love you by having coffee, breakfast ready.

Speaker 2 [00:17:21] Something that you might need without you being told I'm getting ice cream. That she likes going the way things to get something for her. I'm thinking about something before I come home and say, Do you need anything? Can I get you something? And I said with the communication, she deals with a lot of my problem. Then I deal with a problem. But she tried to cop the rap and she had been coping that up. I'm still. I still don't know [Country]. I'm already [70-75]. But she tried to let me know. What is [Country] all about? And to communicate with them. Our problem. Finance.

Speaker 2 [00:18:23] Whatever it might be, vehicles. We even talk about vehicles, what to get the vehicle out to get the vehicle. The dog, The cat. But to me, those are the two two things communication and showing backing. What you're trying to say.

Speaker 1 [00:18:47] Yeah. And concretely, why do you think communication is so important in relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:18:58] Why is what important?

Speaker 1 [00:19:00] Communication.

Speaker 2 [00:19:04] Communication is very important to me in the first place. When you see somebody, you greet them. Good morning. For me, that's communication. When you fell in love with them, you're say, I love you or I like you. That's communication. When you give them something that's a form of communication, vice versa. They do the same thing in communication. You learn what the other person is about. Who are they? What are they and how are they going to deal with it? The same time also. I don't hide anything from her. Everything's very transparent. We put things together. I tell her what is what. How I feel about things. Sometimes she doesn't like what I say, and I take that. I am wrong. And I always say to myself. I am always wrong. Even though I am right, I say I'm wrong. It's better that way. It's so simple because the time that you argued to me, we never had a fight. I don't know what she told you. We have a fight. I don't consider it a fight. It's just a

little disagreement. And to me, fighting is not a good way of doing things. And then later you would say, I'm sorry. That's just a waste of time. Why not just say sorry right there in then? And as I've said, communication makes you. No, the other person. By asking them what they have, what you have, what you got, what they got, and how they deal with it, and how it is just like the question of what, when, where, why, how.

Speaker 1 [00:21:09] Yeah. I think that makes a lot of I think that makes a lot of sense. And could you give an example of a time where you had good communication?

Speaker 2 [00:21:27] I didn't get that one.

Speaker 1 [00:21:28] Yeah, no worries. Could you give an example of a time when you had good communication?

Speaker 2 [00:21:43] A time when we have a bad communication.

Speaker 1 [00:21:46] Good communication. Good.

Speaker 2 [00:21:47] Good communication.

Speaker 1 [00:21:49] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:21:53] We always have a good communication. We never had. As I've said, it's not argue is not arguing it just putting. The negative and the positive. What if we do this? And what if we do that? And then from there we talk about if we do this, what's going to happen? If we don't do it, what's going to happen? It's always said it's the we process. It's not my process. It's not her process.

Speaker 2 [00:22:29] It's just like in the house. Whoever wants to wash the dishes. Wash the dishes. But nobody is going to say, go wash the dishes. Go do this. Go do that. Go do it. No, we don't do that. If she's tired, I understand. I'll take it. I'll do it. If she knows I'm tired, she'll to do it. He doesn't say you do this. I do it. No, it's not. Have been like that. I think they are. Communication have been growing up from the time we met [Year] to present our communication is good and. I don't see any anything that would make it. And we put it down. I think we're still living in.

Speaker 2 [00:23:18] Our life in the [70-75] and [60-65] say saw [60-65] and [70-75]. It's still communicating.

Speaker 1 [00:23:32] Yeah, that's. That's great. I love that. And I'm going to shift gears a little bit into love. So for you. What is love?

Speaker 2 [00:23:48] What is what?

Speaker 1 [00:23:51] For you. What is love?

Speaker 2 [00:23:53] What is love?

Speaker 1 [00:23:54] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:23:59] As the song goes, love is the many splendor thing. So to define it. Love it. It's a showing of affection. Either it's silent or aggressive. It's still. Love is a process

to communicate with somebody that you like them not only like them, but you like them dearly. And being loved in love with the person you want them to be with you when you go to bed. Wake up in the morning and go play with them. Love comes in many shape and form, as you said, giving Flower a mom, giving her coffee in the morning or tea or asking her what she wants. To me, that's love. She likes her pet. I have to like the Pats also because not a lot. And I do like them. I do love them. Love cannot be bought. But love can be expressed. That's how I look at it.

Speaker 1 [00:25:29] Yeah. And how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:37] How far is love?

Speaker 1 [00:25:39] How important love is in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:45] Love is the central thing. for a relationship to survive. Without love, there is no relationship. Without love. There is no communication with no communication. Everything is dead. Love, as I've said. Is the essential, the pillar of life. Love, as I've said, could be expressed in many ways. And it's very, very important in a relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:26:37] Yeah, that makes sense. That makes a lot of sense. And how do you know that? [Partner's Name], your wife loves you.

Speaker 2 [00:26:48] That's a good question.

Speaker 1 [00:26:50] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:26:52] I know why she loved me. When my wife first wife divorced me. Divorced me. I did not divorce she divorced me. I was petitioning. I was in the process of petitioning my mom and my eight brothers and sisters. [Partner's Name] went all the way and said, No problem, will take care of it. I don't have any money. I don't know you. I don't have any knowledge about immigration. But she taught me how to do it. She showed me how to do it and Sid did it. She made the phone call she made the driving, and she showed and she put her card.. She just knew me. Not. We're not even in a relationship at that time, But she already balanced me to do all of those things. Not to me. That is love. And as we grow on.

Speaker 2 [00:27:52] I have a problem with my family, and I don't know how to deal with them because mine was. I'm trying to introduce to them the [Country] culture, but to them it's not the [Nationality] with them. We're still [Nationality], you know, So we have to adhere to the [Nationality] custom. And I said, no, we have to do it. And [Partner's Name] would come up to me and say, You cannot tell them, but if they want to follow you, they'll follow you. They don't. They don't. And as for the fact that we still went and had. A plot with [1-5] bedrooms and [1-5] bathrooms. So when they come in, everybody will be in the house and we have a plan for everything. They came in, we picked them up. They were in the house. And [Partner's Name] was there, even though she doesn't get too much attention from my brothers and sisters. And I would say, I don't know if they are ashamed or they are. They just don't want to talk. I don't know. But [Partner's Name] accompanied them there. At the last moment when they said, we have to leave the house. I said, Fine. They left the house. We talk about it and she was there. She didn't get upset. She didn't say there. They. They just turned their back against me. No, she did not. We made another plan. We communicate with our life. I also have a relative in [Location] who needs money. And I never knew that the student loan. I'm sure you're familiar with it. A student loan that I

signed would be forever. My, my, my debt. So, when she found that out, there were three student loans that I signed and she just said, It's okay, but this is what student loan meant. So I just said I blew it and she didn't get upset. It didn't matter. I didn't get mad. Said, Fine, we'll live with it. And that's good. And all of those we still kept traveling. We went, we went to the [location], we went to [Country], we went through [Continent], we went to the [Country], We went everywhere and nothing. What I said about what I did or nothing was said about negative of my family. That she spend money. I spend money. I know it's not my money that I'm sending to the the [Country]. It's our money. But she said, I keep saying, your problem is my problem. So let's solve the problem.

Speaker 1 [00:30:45] That's really great. I think that's great. I love that you guys have that going for you guys. What would you say? Shifting gears, what would you say are some challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:31:03] What the relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:31:05] Challenges.

Speaker 2 [00:31:13] I didn't get the question.

Speaker 1 [00:31:15] Yeah. What would you say are some challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:31:25] Tradition.

Speaker 1 [00:31:29] Here, let me put it in the chat. Do you see that?

Speaker 2 [00:31:37] Yes. Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:31:38] Okay. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:31:40] So challenges. Culture she's [Nationality]. I'm [Nationality].

Speaker 2 [00:31:58] I'm stubborn, so it's not.

Speaker 2 [00:32:09] I'm not easily persuaded. I stick with my culture. I'm a [religion]. And she's [religion]. But even though we have those challenges. We still. I don't even. I don't even. Say it's really challenges. She is vegan and I'm not. So we tried to go to places that served. Vegetarian. And that would serve also meat. But most of the time I go with her. If she says we go vegan, I'll go vegan. Yes, I do. Crave for meat. But again. I wouldn't die if I don't eat meat. I could always buy meat by myself. But for her to go to a vegan place it it. It's something that's important to her. For me, it's not.

Speaker 2 [00:33:33] So I wouldn't even say it was a challenge because I. I would rather her be happy than me being happy.

Speaker 2 [00:33:47] I'm dealing with challenges, she's. More brighter than I am.

Speaker 2 [00:33:56] So I have to listen to her. And sometimes. It's not like I don't take it, but I kind of like think like, Oh, she knows a lot. What am I supposed to say here? Challenges is not.

Speaker 2 [00:34:23] The challenge, the big challenges that really get me. I hope she doesn't get mad. And I keep saying lose weight. That's the most challenging for me to do. But then again, also I also contribute because I don't make I don't want to make her feel bad. And she tried. I know she tried so hard, but it's just not happening. And I keep also contributing to it. With candy, ice cream and everything, but I think that the most challenges. In our life. But we don't fight about it. We don't fight.

Speaker 2 [00:35:10] But to me, that's the. How can I get her to do it?

Speaker 1 [00:35:22] And aside from communication, what are other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:35:36] To maintain the relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:35:37] Yeah. Aside from communication.

Speaker 2 [00:35:47] I'm things that I do in the house and. Like. I know that she would do it. I'll do it first. I know there are things that they cannot do, and I'll do.

Speaker 2 [00:36:13] Well, that. Um. I don't know. You probably she does, like, making the bed, making sure that everything is set, because I know her, that she wants everything in. And in in a spot where it belongs. And I'm not good at it, so I'll just pull everything out and then put it in my closet. Vacuum the house.

Speaker 2 [00:36:40] Things that she usually does, and I would do it and things that she does that she cannot do it. And I'll do that. And as I said, serving her coffee and sometimes not flowers anymore before flowers now, she said. It just it doesn't do anything anymore. I'm bringing her food, cooking food at one point. Arranging the house. Those are the only things that I could think of. Doing things that I'm not being told to do it, but I know that she would love to do it and she would like to be done.

Speaker 1 [00:37:34] Yeah. No, that makes a lot of sense. And would you say that the relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2 [00:37:45] The relationship is good for me. She had proven it. And I think if I had. stuck with my first wife. It would've end up in a divorce anyway. She filed a divorce, I did not. But probably in the later years I would have filed a divorce. [Partner's Name] always asked me something about a problem. When there is a letter coming from my family or from even [Name] or anything like that. She doesn't open it. My previous wife open it and get upset. She always thinks that. I have. Of privacy in my life. Even though in our house. She doesn't. She never went. I've known that for many years to the present day. She never had gone to my closet. And I'm glad it never did, because she won't like what's in my closet. And that's one thing. And I think our relationship is getting a strong. The time that. I would say people would choose whether to live with somebody else and not to live with somebody else has already gone. And now we're looking at volumes and base of life that we will grow older together. And deal with the problem together. And she has been very supportive with everything. And I would just say vaguely to you, I wouldn't. I specify while number it 1 2 3. But she's been very good and I never had any repent. Of having her in my life. And yes, probably if I had married somebody or married another one or if they were my. First. wife Things would never change. I would still be. But a big

question mark as to where is [Location] or where is too penal [Country], where to do things. I will still maintain my own traditions. And because of what she taught me, whenever I go home, I'm proud of myself, of what I learned from her. But I could apply it and not in any way bragging it, but just doing the right thing. And I'm grateful for her. And I'm grateful for her that she doesn't look money as a source of happiness. Where my first love does. Look at it that way. And she's very caring. And I think we're just beginning again.

Speaker 1 [00:41:09] Yeah, that's great. I love that. Um, and then gears a little bit again. Do you think the relationship changed, you? And if so, in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:41:28] You're coming in very garble.

Speaker 1 [00:41:31] Let me. Put it in the chat, but. Well, what I was wondering was: Did the relationship change you, in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:41:53] It changed me in the outlook of life. At one point. It's just like being in America and working, sending money. And. Not going out of the box. Keep working. And send money to the [Country]. With her coming into my life, it opens up the door. There is another world out there. That there is another. Place to go. There is another coffee shop. A restaurant. To go and enjoy. There is another food. There's another place of line. And in spite of what we did, we still have not. And we haven't still forgotten my family. And we still send them money. We still send them things. We'll send some random stuff. And the process of of the relationship. It's going a step by step, but it's not going down. It's going up. As I've said, it's another pace of life being no kids and having relatives on the other side. That needs your support. So she's coming in and going? Yes. Support them. Yes. Do they? Yes. Do that? Yes. Do it and we'll do it together. And I like that because I don't I really don't want. To enforce and to her that that this is what I want to do because it wasn't her problem even though I keep saying this is a we. But then in this situation, I think I don't want her to. I don't want to drag her to my problem. I want her to be happy. I want that problem of mine to be mine alone. But even the fact that I have that problem, I never put pressure on her. I never do anything. To to discourage her or get her angry. And I think if I had. With her and how her. Everything is going well. And. We're looking forward again to. Our new. New place of life. We're thinking about moving. We're thinking of not moving. Where would we be? I'm thinking about having a knee surgery. Who would take care of me? Who would take care of her? Who would do things? And. And she's always right there. She never left. She always talked to me about things that are positive. And yes, there are negative. She explain to me what is the negative and what is the positive? The communication is. Is there. And as I've said, it's not like before when we were the [30-40s]. Now we're in the [60-70s]. It it's it's a different situation. And. I could say that I could see her and me walking down the street limping with our cane. I cannot ask for more.

Speaker 1 [00:46:02] Yeah, that is absolutely amazing. I'm wondering, do you think that [Partner's Name] is the same, has stayed the same before the relationship as they are now or if they changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:46:19] I didn't get that.

Speaker 1 [00:46:22] Um, I'm wondering if [Partner's Name] is the same for the relationship as they are now.

Speaker 2 [00:46:30] I think she is. She is one person that doesn't that is not shy to say how she feel. And I like that. And we always say to one another that there is a problem. We always have to say it. We always have to speak about it. We have to communicate. We cannot leave the other person in the dark. If we want the relationship to survive. And we have been doing that and. And I think she's happy. Because I could see her. Living with her for that long time and married with her over that long time. I also could see how how her face would show in the morning when I say good morning. In the evening when we say good night, when we watch TV. When we eat. When we go outside. I. I look at her face. If there are changes, I cannot just judge it by the tone of her voice, by saying, yeah, I'm okay. But it's like looking at the eye and looking at the way he says it. I am okay. I am fine. I am good. I think. I think she likes where we are. But see, we're better if we have more money.

Speaker 1 [00:48:07] Yeah. And. Kind of shifting gears again. Sorry, I can't do that. You're not listening to iTunes. Sorry. It keeps activating Siri. Another question I had was Do you feel safe in the relationship and why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:48:31] Which one again?

Speaker 1 [00:48:33] Do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:48:40] Yes. I feel safe in the relationship. And why I say that. You could tell people. By the way they are. Whether they're faking it or they're not faking it. It has to come with words, emotion and action. And as I've said before, with the I love, you know what I love? It doesn't mean anything. It does a good morning, but if it's being backed with action and emotion. Then it's something else. We're here with her. Of all those years. From the very beginning, when we were just friends, she was already behind me. She was coaching with things to do. What not to do. What to say. What not to say. She had been. Table eight is one of the things that said showed me what to do and none of my friends had shown me what to do. We go to my friends house who are all [Nationality], that eat meat and she don't eat meat. She doesn't show any any bad feeling or bad emotion or bad action. She plays along and does things right. And I think I would say it's much safer now because we have crossed.

Speaker 2 [00:50:21] The page we're in, one would say. I do. I do. I want to stay with this person or I don't want to stay with this person. We have crossed that boundary. Now we are on the other side. Now that I depend on her and she depend on me. We don't have any children. It's only us. I'm safe with her. She's safe with me. We talk about things that it's not happening. Like finances. Where to go? What to do, what to eat. Where to eat. What not to eat. And from the very beginning, she had been my safety net. And I never doubted or heard that. The only reason that I think at one point that I had doubted her is not because of love, but because of the tradition and the culture. I am a [Nationality] and she is. [Nationality]. And when we first met, she thought I was [Nationality]. And I wasn't a [Nationality]. I was a [Nationality]. And so you haven't even heard about the [Country] or the [Country] is, till I brought her there. So when she saw the place, you just kind of like, No. So this is your [Country]. And when we came back, I kind of doubted it. Well, now she saw. Who I am, where I am, where I came from with this thing. Stay with it and she did. And I think that was the part that I doubted it. And today I would say yes.

Speaker 2 [00:52:26] So I would say our relationship is safe. Nothing is coming between us.

Speaker 1 [00:52:40] Yeah, that's great. I love that you guys both have really good safety in your relationship. The next part of this interview is going to use, like, a scale. So I'm going to share my screen. Can you see this? Yes. Okay. Awesome. So I'm going to. Tell you stay statement and you're going to stay. Tell me what number you think it applies to you. So my partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker 2 [00:53:19] Nine.

Speaker 1 [00:53:20] Nine. Okay. And why not eight?

Speaker 2 [00:53:26] I don't say it's eight, because if there was a ten, I would say ten.

Speaker 1 [00:53:35] Okay. Yeah, great. What about my partner? Usually is responsive to my needs.

Speaker 2 [00:53:45] Nine.

Speaker 1 [00:53:47] Okay. And once again, why not eight.

Speaker 2 [00:53:50] Again, if there's a ten, I would say it's ten because. She's that kind of person. That is not selfish. She's that kind of person. That. That, that. That thinks. And I do think also that what makes me happy makes her happy. And what makes her happy makes me happy.

Speaker 1 [00:54:20] Really great. Next question is how satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:54:27] Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:54:30] Okay, great. And then based on the scale from from 0 to 10, how would how satisfied would you say you are with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:54:41] Ten.

Speaker 1 [00:54:43] Great. And why not? Like I said before, why not nine or eight?

Speaker 2 [00:54:48] Why not nine or eight? If I would say nine or eight. I would be lying because it's not nine. It's not eight. It's 11, actually. And. I can not really express more how I am satisfied with the relationship, what we are doing, the communication, the love and all the angles that we have in life. And I know there are problems. I have friends who have problems. And we don't have that because we never met that. We never had the selfishness. We never had the thing of keeping our money on our own money. Your bank is my bank. Your food is my food. We don't have that. So it could be 11. If there's an 11 in the relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:55:51] That is so great. And I really love that for you. It seems like you're very satisfied with the relationship. I have a few more questions and then we're done. So these next two questions are more about your physical intimacy as a couple and if this is too sensitive for you to share. Feel free to say, Tell me. And we don't. We can skip over these questions, but. These days. How often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:56:28] I didn't get that.

Speaker 1 [00:56:29] Okay, Let me put it in the chat.

Speaker 2 [00:56:32] Yes, please.

Speaker 1 [00:56:33] Yes. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:56:44] You're funny.

[00:56:46] You know what?

Speaker 2 [00:56:48] This morning I told her. I said I. What's the name of the kid?

Speaker 2 [00:56:54] I said, [Name]. And I said, Now what is he going to ask? Do you have sex every day? Do you have this every day? And she said, no, she wouldn't ask that. It's not educational. I said, Oh, well, if she would asked. And I said, if she would ask. This is my. This is my answer.

Speaker 1 [00:57:11] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:57:12] It's messy now.

Speaker 2 [00:57:30] Not so often. And. I would say that. It's one of the subject probably that I don't touch. You could tell a person especially Your partner. And they want sex or not. And sex is to me, it's just a game. It's an exercise. And I toddler her this morning.

Speaker 2 [00:58:03] If you were to ask me, I say to [Name], Yes, nowadays it's too messy. Too many things to do. Not like before. When you were young, did that. Dang it,. So no. And I am not. I'm not complaining. And I do understand. And. I know there are couples who fight because they are the one would not give the other one. And to me, no. I still have lots of respect for her. And I know she would like it. So we just I keep telling her, tap me in the back and say, let's do it. I'm on.

Speaker 2 [00:58:44] And yes, not as much as before.

Speaker 1 [00:58:55] I'm glad you found the question really funny.

Speaker 2 [00:58:59] Oh, I'm going. To tell her about that you asked.

Speaker 1 [00:59:01]. She was very honest about that question. And yes, the next question is quite similar. How satisfied are you with your sex life? I can put it in the chat, too.

Speaker 2 [00:59:31] Now. Yes. I'm. I'm. I'm satisfied. I'm before us. It's different. You crave for it. You want it.

Speaker 2 [00:59:46] I think, as you grow older. You don't pray for it and you like to do it. But you still have to respect your partner also. You don't force into them. As I've said. I keep telling her that if she's in the mood or wants to go to do a stop in the back and we do it. I have.

[01:00:12] We have.

Speaker 2 [01:00:15] Great one when we were young. Okay now. We wish we'd done it all. Driving a sports car into driving a what is a van now?

Speaker 2 [01:00:33] Yes, I am satisfied with my sex life.very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [01:00:47] Okay, great. So we are close to wrapping up. I would just like to summarize what we've talked about in the past hour is. It seems like you guys both really love each other and. The way that you think that your relationship is very high quality. Because of your love for each other and also because you communicate with each other a lot. You also don't think you fight very often or you don't think if I ever. And you feel very safe in the relationship and your overall satisfaction relationship is very high. Is there anything that I missed or that you would like to add?

Speaker 2 [01:01:43] Make sure what you're coming in.

Speaker 1 [01:01:47] Yeah. Is there anything you would like to add? Like. Based on what we just talked about.

Speaker 2 [01:02:04] All I could say is I wish I had met her when she was young. Not when. Not when I was already a little bit. Not really old, but I wish I. I met her when she was young. And. I don't think I have anything to add. She's great. She's warm. Very understanding. She makes. Our relationship grow. And she haven't stopped. I'm still learning a lot from her. She was my teacher. A best friend. A good friend. A wife, A partner. And since. I would say my life now. I depend on her. And as I said, I wish. I met her when she was young.

Speaker 1 [01:03:39] Yeah, that makes a lot of sense. Yeah. Um, before we end this, I just want to let you know how the transcripts will be or how we will handle our data. Um, would you like me to put this on the chart as well? Yeah. I'm going to put this in the chapter so that you can read it and then you can tell me which option you think is better. I can also read out loud. But option one is that Transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. And if you're bolder, another option in the whole transcript can be shared Remove sensitive and overly identifying details so it will be anonymized. Although this option, there's a minimal chance that someone who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down who among their colleagues they believe it is.

Speaker 2 [01:04:44] So it could be shared.

Speaker 1 [01:04:45] Okay. Everything okay? Awesome. Um. And last thing before we end, thank you so much for participating in the study. Just, you know, this has been done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and in the U.S. So it is a pretty worldwide study. And one thing that we want to ask of you is if you would know any other couples or people who might know other couples who would be potentially interested in being interviewed. I already talked to [Partner's Name] about this, and she had a few in mind. So if you don't know any, that is totally fine and I will text her. So, yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:05:40] I lost many of my friends.

Speaker 1 [01:05:42] Okay. Yeah, that is totally okay. I will. I will reach out to [Partner's Name], and she seems to have a few in mind, so that is totally okay. I totally understand.

Speaker 2 [01:05:54] Okay.

Speaker 1 [01:05:55] Yes. Okay. That concludes everything. Do you have any other questions for me.

Speaker 2 [01:06:01] No. Do you still want to talk to [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 1 [01:06:04] No, that's okay. I will text her there. Good. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:06:10] And I thank you very much.

Speaker 1 [01:06:11] Yeah, I think.

Speaker 2 [01:06:12] It's a pleasure.

Speaker 1 [01:06:13] Yes. Yes, you too. Thank you so much. Thank you so much. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:06:22] Oh.